

YI ZHANG (BETTY)

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PROJECT MANAGEMENT | AI × EDUCATION | DATA & PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

Education professional transitioning into project management with experience designing learning experiences, coordinating multi-stakeholder initiatives, and translating user needs into practical solutions. Combines hands-on expertise in early childhood and gifted education with growing technical skills in AI, Python, SQL, and data analytics. Experienced in project planning, curriculum/product design, user feedback, iterative improvement, and AI-assisted product development.

EXPERIENCE

HELIOS SCHOOL

Kindergarten Associate

Sunnyvale, CA

Aug 2025 – Present

- Co-design and implement differentiated, interdisciplinary learning experiences for kindergarten students, translating classroom observations and learner needs into age-appropriate lessons, projects, and classroom experiences.
- Collaborate with teachers and grade-level teams to plan curriculum, develop project-based learning experiences, support individual learning goals, and adapt instruction based on student engagement and learning outcomes.
- Manage multiple concurrent priorities across lesson preparation, classroom implementation, student support, assessment, documentation, and family communication in a fast-paced gifted-education environment.
- Apply knowledge of early childhood and gifted education to identify learning needs, propose instructional strategies, and improve learning experiences that support student agency, critical thinking, creativity, and social-emotional development.
- Partner with educators and families to communicate student progress, identify areas for support, and coordinate next steps based on student needs.

SELF-INITIATED AT-HOME LEARNING PROJECT

Learning Specialist & Curriculum Designer

Hybrid

Nov 2023 – Jul 2025

- Designed and implemented 20+ Montessori-inspired, hands-on learning products and activities focused on phonemic awareness, number sense, executive functioning, and other developmental skills.
- Led end-to-end curriculum/product development, from identifying learning needs and defining activity objectives to creating instructional materials, guides, and video tutorials for families.
- Collected and analyzed parent feedback and website analytics to identify user needs, prioritize improvements, and iteratively refine learning materials and delivery.
- Built and maintained digital product content using Wix and Canva, improving accessibility and usability for families implementing learning activities at home.

OPTICA EDUCATION

Educational Consultant

Remote

Jul 2022 – Nov 2023

- Collaborated with a small consulting team to coordinate monthly planning meetings, professional learning discussions, and student-support initiatives.
- Developed individualized academic and goal-setting plans by translating student needs into structured milestones, reflection activities, and progress checkpoints.
- Facilitated 1:1 and small-group coaching focused on executive functioning, time management, confidence-building, communication, and student self-advocacy.
- Partnered with families through virtual conferences and written progress summaries, translating student progress into clear, actionable strategies and next steps.

SELECTED PRODUCT & TECHNICAL PROJECTS

SOULIE — Emotional Wellness Product for Children & Parents

Product Development Project

2026

- Identified an opportunity to help children ages 4–10 better understand and express their emotions, while helping parents respond to children's emotional needs with greater empathy and confidence.
- Defined primary and secondary users, product goals, core user journeys, and MVP features around a three-stage experience: **Know Yourself, Choose Yourself, and Give Yourself.**

- Developed a product requirements document covering user needs, feature architecture, interaction principles, emotional check-ins, self-guided support tools, growth journaling, parent-facing insights, and privacy considerations.
- Used AI-assisted development tools, including OpenAI Codex, to translate product requirements into prototype functionality and iteratively refine product flows, features, and implementation.
- Applied an education-informed perspective to balance child usability, developmental appropriateness, caregiver needs, and user agency throughout product planning.

SOCIAL GRAPH-BASED RESTAURANT RECOMMENDATION SYSTEM

Academic Team Project | Team of 5

- Collaborated with a five-member team to design a personalized restaurant discovery system addressing decision fatigue and the limitations of generic review- and rating-based recommendations.
- Framed restaurant discovery as a personalized ranking problem using social connections, user preferences, location, time, and behavioral signals to improve recommendation relevance.
- Contributed to a hybrid recommendation approach combining LightGCN embeddings, Jaccard-weighted social influence, candidate filtering, and feature-driven ranking using the Yelp Open Dataset.
- Developed and evaluated an interactive prototype with recommendation explanations, social-graph visualization, score breakdowns, and location-based discovery; the system was deployed as a React/Vite application.
- Evaluated recommendations across 17,221 users and 435,744 held-out interactions; the proposed model improved NDCG@10 by approximately 12% over the popularity baseline.

EDUCATION

GEORGIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

M.S. in Data Analytics

Expected 2027

Relevant Coursework / Technical Training: Python, SQL, Data Analytics, Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning Foundations

TEACHERS COLLEGE, COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY

M.A. in Early Childhood Education

New York, NY

Sep 2020 – Feb 2022

Activities: TCCS Outreach and Communication Member

WHITMAN COLLEGE

B.A. in Sociology and Rhetoric Studies

Walla Walla, WA

Aug 2016 – May 2020

Awards: Whitman Internship Grant (2019); Outstanding Support of International Student Services (2020)

Activities: Admission Assistant; Power & Privilege Symposium Marketing & Communication Director

SKILLS

Project & Product: Project Management, Product Requirements, User-Centered Design, Curriculum/Product Development, User Needs Analysis, Feature Prioritization, Stakeholder Communication, Project-Based Learning

AI & Technical: Generative AI, AI-Assisted Development, OpenAI Codex, Python, SQL, Data Analytics, Tableau

Product & Collaboration Tools: Figma, Notion, Monday.com, Google Workspace, Wix, Canva

Education & Domain Expertise: Early Childhood Education, Gifted Education, Social-Emotional Learning, Differentiated Instruction, Montessori-Inspired Learning, PBL

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), French (Beginner)

CERTIFICATION

Responsive Classroom — Classroom Management that Works for Special Area Teachers | Dec 2025